Community waiting list within 18 weeks

Outturn for September 2026 · forecast issued with data through August 2026

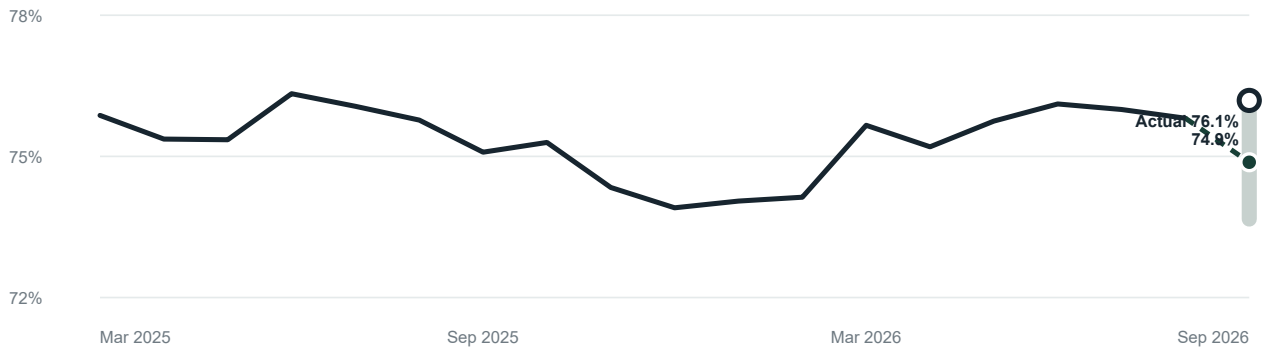
The published result was 76.1%. It was broadly unchanged from the previous result and was 1.2pp better than outlook · outside the 80% range.

AT FORECAST · AUGUST 2026	FORECAST · SEPTEMBER 2026	ACTUAL
75.8%	**74.9%**	**76.1%**
Known when the forecast was made	80% expected range 73.8%–75.9%	Broadly unchanged from the previous result · 1.2pp better than outlook · outside the 80% range
		Off course · 78% by March 2027

Mar 2027 outlook at issue Projected **75.6%** Target **≥78%** Model-implied chance **15%**

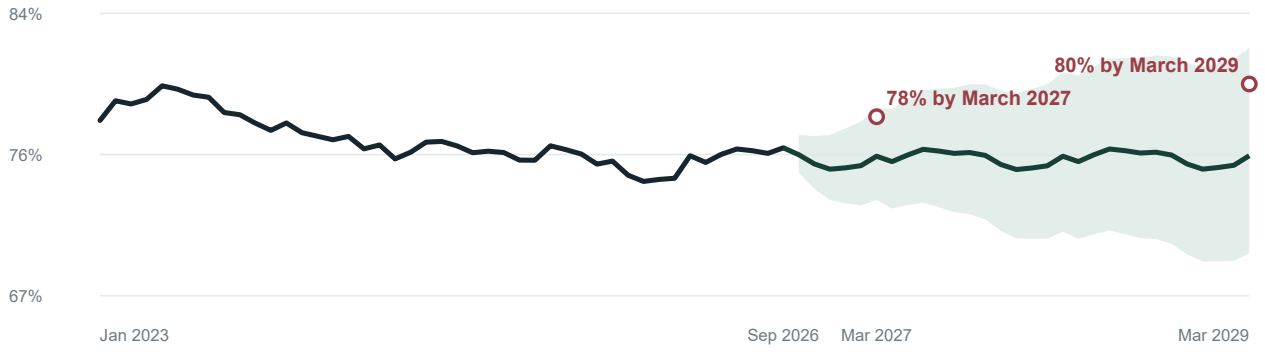
Recent performance and current release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 80% by March 2029. 2.8pp below milestone

Data: NHS England community health services waiting lists. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework interim target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target

Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 45 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 12 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 12 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

Community waiting list within 18 weeks

Distribution and trajectory watch · September 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



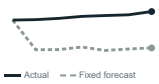
Moderate = 1–<2×; marked = at least 2× the metric-specific materiality threshold.

Trajectory watch

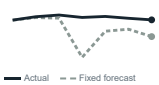
Six actual months are compared with one forecast path fixed before that window. Both lines begin at the same observed value. A low performer can be improving, while a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the latest actual minus the fixed forecast for that same month; the six-month window checks persistence.

47	15	9	23
providers assessed	sustained favourable	sustained adverse	without an active signal

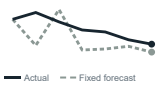
Largest sustained favourable moves

UNIVERSITY HOSPITALS PLYMOUTH NHS TRUST
Latest 83.2% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


35.6pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

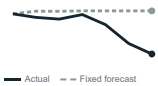
ST GEORGE'S UNIVERSITY HOSPITALS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 73.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


32.4pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

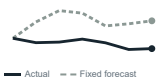
DONCASTER AND BASSETLAW TEACHING HOSPITALS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 27.5% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


16.3pp
LATEST MONTH: ABOVE FORECAST

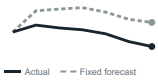
Largest sustained adverse moves

SHERWOOD FOREST HOSPITALS NHS FOUNDATION TRUST
Latest 86.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


13.4pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

WALSALL HEALTHCARE NHS TRUST
Latest 61.8% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


11.9pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

WHITTINGTON HEALTH NHS TRUST
Latest 60.0% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier
Forecast fixed before the six-month window


10.5pp
LATEST MONTH: BELOW FORECAST

Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. The displayed gap is the latest actual minus the fixed forecast for that same month. A signal requires a material latest-month gap and at least five of six months in that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.

Community waits by service

England · September 2026

SERVICE MIX

Where waits over 18 weeks are concentrated

Adult and children and young people services are shown separately. The ranking is descriptive, not a forecast or provider comparison.

47

services with a reported total waiting list

43

services with complete over-18-week bands

SERVICE	TOTAL WAITING	OVER 18 WEEKS	WITHIN 18 WEEKS
Community paediatric service (Children and young people)	169,596	127,119	25.0%
Musculoskeletal service (Adult)	475,246	78,962	83.4%
Therapy interventions: Speech and language (Children and young people)	56,763	20,227	64.4%
Podiatry and podiatric surgery (Adult)	114,116	15,675	86.3%
Therapy interventions: Physiotherapy (Adult)	52,223	5,978	88.6%
Therapy interventions: Occupational therapy (Children and young people)	18,896	5,827	69.2%
Nursing and Therapy support for LTCs: Continence/ colostomy (Adult)	43,696	5,537	87.3%
Therapy interventions: Dietetics (Adult)	36,112	5,270	85.4%
Audiology (Adult)	16,481	4,804	70.9%
Therapy interventions: Speech and language (Adult)	27,561	4,316	84.3%
Rehabilitation services (integrated) (Adult)	41,945	3,455	91.8%
Audiology (Children and young people)	14,746	3,205	78.3%
Therapy interventions: Physiotherapy (Children and young people)	20,628	2,946	85.7%
Neurorehabilitation (multi-disciplinary) (Adult)	13,796	2,406	82.6%
Therapy interventions: Dietetics (Children and young people)	8,033	2,043	74.6%

Coverage and interpretation. Ranked by the published number waiting over 18 weeks. Complete over-18 bands were available for 43 of 47 services with a reported total. Rows with suppressed or incomplete bands are excluded from the ranking. The national headline on page 1 remains the authoritative aggregate. The within-18-week percentage is total waiting less published over-18-week bands, divided by the total. Published weekly bands may not reconcile exactly to the total; reconciliation differences are retained in QA.